My kindergarten is at the museum is a pilot program initiated by Høgskollen in Western Norway, in collaboration with the University Museum in Bergen and
Audience development at the City Council Department for Climate, Culture and Industry in, Bergen Municipality.
Thanks to the Cultural History at Bergen University Museum and the kindergartens who agreed to participate and made the pilot possible.

MOVING CHILDREN'S HOLIDAYS INTO THE MUSEUM

- What can happen if the kindergarten was at the museum?

HOW TO COME ON THE PROJECT

http://myschoolatthemuseum.site/

WE WANT TO EXAMINE

The idea for the program originates from the project "My primary school is at the museum" which became
designed by Wendy James and developed by the Cultural Institute at King's College London, England. This English
The project was presented at a conference where one of the researchers in our project participated. For more information,
see:

The program will test the co-location of kindergartens and art / cultural institutions and inspire closer interaction and partnership between the institutions. The program aims:

• To challenge how one can think of art and cultural institutions as a base for play and learning for children in kindergarten age.
• Contribute to academic exchanges and closer cooperation between kindergarten and museum.
• To explore and develop aesthetic learning processes and dissemination methods in the field of practice.
• Creating a different kindergarten everyday and that can give children a sense of ownership, identity and
meaning to the museum's surroundings, space and function.

We want to investigate what happens when kindergarten children are in museum surroundings for a longer period of time. How to create an experience of belonging and ownership of the cultural spaces of society that a museum represents? My kindergarten is at the museum can also mean my place is at the museum where the transformation lies in going from visitors who are just an hour or two, to "moving in" where one can often develop ownership, create meaning and identity to the museum.

The actual implementation of the project will in practice say that the kindergarten for a period replaces the kindergarten's familiar room with the museum's premises and has its permanent base there. It is the kindergarten's actual life in the museum and activities there that are the main focus of the project and the report.

We also wanted to look at the staging of the kindergarten's relocation process to and from the museum. This can be preparing activities and evaluation work together with the children afterwards in the kindergarten and at home.

The kindergarten's staff are caregivers in a daycare day. An adult in the kindergarten should, in addition to being a safe adult, also facilitate play and learning that makes sense for the children. The kindergartens often have their own planned projects where one explores themes, rooms and materials over a shorter or longer period of time with the children. Such projects often take place in the kindergarten's indoor and outdoor areas, where one uses his or her own available resources, experience and expertise.

MUSEUM AS INSTITUTION AND THEIR ROLE OF SOCIETY

There are large and small, well-known and more unknown museums in Bergen and the surrounding area. Some are state-owned and others run privately or by organizations and often by enthusiasts. Everyone has the purpose of safeguarding and communicating something from our environment and cultural heritage.

The international museum organization ICOM (International Council of Museums) bases the following on the definition of museums and thus the museum operation in Norway: "A museum is a permanent, public-benefit institution in the service of society and society that is open to the public. A museum collects, preserves , research and disseminate and exhibit material and intangible

sources of knowledge about people and the environment for study purposes, education and entertainment ".
The political signals of the museums' social roles are relatively general and open and allow the museums to interpret the role of society in different ways. A rapidly changing society also challenges the museum as an institution and its functions. Opening hours, availability, exhibitions and the experience of a place to be are

The museums have a high level of expertise in their field, this can be exhibitions and topics that are communicated. They have good experience in welcoming an audience and facilitating dissemination and workshops over shorter time intervals, but often have less pedagogical knowledge or experience in receiving children's groups that will be present at the museum for a long time. It is therefore interesting to look at what can happen when we combine the institutions' professional expertise and experiences, as well as what significance this can have for children's experiences in an interaction with the museum rooms, its objects and exhibitions.

Among the factors that will affect visitor interest and their use of the museum. It will also be a matter of access to necessary resources, finances and working conditions. Focus areas and choice of target groups will also affect how one chooses, for example, to facilitate exhibition design, reception and dissemination programs. In a note from the Arts Council on the future museum, a general assessment is made of the sector and says that the museums must develop to become more democratic and inclusive. Our project can be a step in the right direction in that respect. For more information: https://www.kulturradet.no/documents/10157/239d827f-0d57-4cfd-a0cf-fe8cc8eba7e3

UNIVERSITY MUSEUM IN THE MOUNTAIN

The University Museum in Bergen includes the Natural History and Cultural History Museum, as well as the Museum Garden. These thrones at the height between the mouse plaza, Villaveien and the University of Bergen.
identify where resource utilization can be improved, or where more resources need to be deployed. See: https://www.uib.no/universitetsmuseet

CULTURAL HISTORICAL MUSEUM

The Museum Garden

The museum garden is a preserved, old botanical garden. In the garden today there are about 3000 different species and together they constitute an exhibition of living plants that can be sensed. The garden serves as a welcome green lung and recreation area for the city's people and visitors. This space was also part of the project's outdoor area. Here, the children could see, smell and touch on well-known and unknown plants, learn what they were talking about and their history, and learn how to treat the garden and plants with respect so that it is preserved.

NYGÅRD FIRED

Nygårdsparken is not part of the university museum, but will play a role in the project. It is the city's largest park and is within a minute's walk of the museum. Here one can run on open lawns and climb the trees. The park has been renovated in recent years and in this connection got a small cafe. Around the café area there is a pavilion with superstructures and seating, trampolines and ropes that invite many different activities. The kindergarten was happy to come here the last hour of the day for play and free show.

MUSEUMS AND CHILDREN'S HAGES

Many kindergartens visit museums, both as part of planned theme work and as more individual excursions. In relation to kindergartens' central management tools, the Framework Plan for the kindergarten, the kindergarten shall contribute to growth and development in a number of areas. Among other things, the kindergarten will promote formation. It can be done by trying diligently and curiously to the outside world. The kindergarten is intended to promote the children's belonging to society, nature and culture. Here, museum visits will be a topical instrument. Furthermore, the kindergarten

natural history objects. It is at the time of writing in a major construction and conversion project with
The museum is one
regional competence and communication center with some of Norway's largest collections of culture and culture
aim to develop greater professionalism in the areas of activity: research, management and dissemination. The project should
also develop and
The Department of Cultural History includes the fields of archeology, anthropology and art and cultural history.
It was in this building that "My kindergarten is in the museum" was carried out and the kindergarten had its own
solid base. The building extends over several floors and flies with a majestic staircase that ties everything
together. Here are exhibitions that convey archaeological objects and discoveries like
human history, church and folk art. The Department of Cultural History also includes unique collections
from recent times in Bergen, including Bergen's theater history and the plastic whale.

promote learning. The children will experience a stimulating environment that supports their desire to play, explore, learn and master. Introduction of a museum as a learning arena falls naturally in here. Museum visits can also be included in two other of the kindergarten's purpose, such as promoting friendship and community and promoting communication and language. A museum visit together with several others provides a community experience, one gets a common reference to talk about and process both while one is there and afterwards. The use of a museum could also play an important role in the seven disciplines that will contribute to promoting well-being, versatile development and health.
See: https://www.udir.no/laring-og-trivsel/rammepla

IMPLEMENTATION OF THE PROJECT WITH CHILDREN'S CARE
THE CHILDREN'S AND THE CHILDREN'S GROUPS
Two kindergartens had their base at the museum during the school year 2018 - 2019, a kindergarten in the fall and one in the spring. Each of the kindergartens was a period of eight days that went over two weeks. The weekdays were Tuesday and until Friday. Mondays, the museum has closed.
Kindergarten 1 with 16 children in pre-school age (autumn 2018) Kindergarten 2 with 16 children in pre-school age (spring 2019)
PREPARATION IN THE CHILDHOOD

In consultation with the kindergarten staff, it was planned how to prepare the children for moving their everyday life from the kindergarten to the museum.
Invitation letter from the museum to the kindergarten. To welcome the children and create expectations.
Conversation with the children to wonder. Examples of questions for the children: What is a museum? What does a museum look like? What can we do at a museum? Can a museum make a sound? Can it be completely silent? Are there secrets there? Can anyone stay at a museum? Can one sleep there? What makes a museum happy? Can it eat? Is it old? What does it mean to be old?
Suitcases: The children are assigned to bring a suitcase / bag from home to the kindergarten. These are ready in the kindergarten until the day of departure.
Drawing assignment - The journey to the museum / My kindergarten at the museum.
The day before departure: Check in the suitcases.
Dramatic play. Adult is a countertop (adult in role). The kids arrive and check in the suitcase. The lawyer asks the children a couple of questions and writes the children's answers to a note that is then attached to the suitcase. Example of check-in questions: Where should the suitcase be? What will it experience / see there?

The day of departure came the children to the kindergarten, picked up the suitcases and traveled by bus to the destination site.
The suitcases stay at the museum throughout the implementation of the project. The children did not travel with them every day, but only the first day when they arrived at the museum and the project last day.

ON THE MUSEUM
Kindergartens were given a setup for a day plan in advance. The plan was to make the stay clear and more predictable for the kindergarten, but also for the museum and their planning of the project. The times were flexible with room for change.

Kindergarten 1
The kindergarten participated in the autumn of 2018. The actual move to the museum was carried out the project in weeks 38 and 39. The first day of arrival the museum was Tuesday 18 September. last day was Friday 28 Sept. A total of eight days. Fixed base / room in the museum: The crypt
The name of the intermediary is anonymised
Organization day:
At 10am arrival the museum. Be greeted by the host / museum facilitator
10.15 - 11.15: Arrangement with museum facilitator. Hiking / experience inside the museum. 11.30 - 12.00: Dining.

12.00 - 13.00: Frilek outside - Nygårdsparken
13.00 - 14.00: Self-directed workshops / observations and play in the Botanical garden. 2 pm: Back to the kindergarten.
Planned workshops / communication experiences
Week 38 Tuesday:
Wednesday Thursday:
Friday:
Week 39 Tuesday: Wednesday: Thursday:
Friday:
We meet Larva Laura who will be with the kids every day. Visit the village exhibition and hear the story of the reef and the bear. Sissel
Stone Age Exhibition. From hunting to animal husbandry. Sissel Church art exhibition. How did they make colors in the Middle Ages. Sissel kl. 1pm: Drama as method, Botanical garden. Berit
The suitcase's journey into the museum. Silvie
Plastic whale. We investigate how much plastic marine animals eat. Sissel and Erik Muséhagen and Museum of Natural History. Life
Eternal life - ancient Egypt. We look at the mummies in the exhibition and explore skarabeen's place in ancient Egypt. Sissel
kl. 1pm: Drama as method, Botanical garden. Berit
The day of departure. Pack your bags and travel back to the kindergarten.

Kindergarten 2
The kindergarten participated in the spring of 2019 and carried out the project in the museum weeks 14 and 15. The first day of arrival the museum was April 2, last day Friday April 12. A total of eight days.
Fixed base / room in the museum: Studio
The name of the intermediary is anonymised
2 pm: Back to the kindergarten.
In the museum - organizing day
At 10.15 the museum arrives. Be greeted by the host / museum facilitator. Find the kindergarten's permanent base inside the museum.
10.30 - 11.15: Arrangement with museum facilitator. Hiking / experience inside the museum.

11.15 - 11.45: Collection with drawing assignment in the museum's studio.
11.45 - 12.15: Dining.
12.15 - 12.30: Dress, observations in the Botanical garden. 12:30 - 14:00: Frilek Nygårdsparken.
Planned dissemination programs and workshops with the museum's intermediaries
The museum staff was responsible for a total of four dissemination programs, as well as practicality
museum.
Tuesday, April 2: Welcome to the museum and get to know the caterpillar Laura in the program Philosophy with animal watching. Intermediaries: Heidi and Mette
Rios and Ødemotland, Høgskulen in Western Norway 2019
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Wednesday, April 3: Whale, plastic and man. Mediator: Heidi Tuesday, April 9: Eternal life - ancient Egypt. Mediator: Heidi Wednesday, April 10. The hunt for the Viking cat. Conveyor: Mette
There was also a communication program with drama pedagogue Sølvi
Thursday, April 11: What happens at the museum at night. The suitcase's journey in the museum. Drama as a method.
Tuesday, April 2 (first day): The big trip - the children come to the kindergarten, pick up the suitcase and travel to the museum. Arrival museum, building, rooms. Get to know the rooms that will be the main base. Get acquainted with rules, new routines, museum staff and more. Meet the museum publishers Heidi and Mette.
Friday, April 12 (Last day in the museum): Get ready for departure. Pack your suitcase and take your goodbye
the museum travels back to the kindergarten.

Last day and arrival daycare:
It was planned that the suitcases should be checked in when they were back in kindergartens. New countertop with questions: Where has the suitcase been? What has it experienced? Write down the children's answers. Maybe the kids can draw their answers?
Suggestions for activities for follow-up were: Unpacking the suitcase (is there anything inside it? Something specific or abstract?). Creating an expression that shows what one has experienced. Show connections between the museum and the kindergarten, Kofferten tells. Exhibition in kindergarten with suitcases.
New invitation from the museum.
Within a given period of time, the children were given the opportunity to bring their adults to the museum and show them the museum.
This offer was free for the family.
FIRST RELEASES AND REFLECTIONS
Rios and Ødemotland, Høgskulen in Western Norway 2019
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The feedback from both of the kindergartens involved has been very positive. Both children and adults felt that they developed a strong ownership of the museum and its surroundings. Some of the excitement was to discover what a museum is, what a museum can accommodate, experience its exhibits, get close to some objects, feel the smell, wonder and discover the stories in and around the museum. The children expressed that the museum was an important place and they showed an eagerness and curiosity about what was around them. Some of the children thought it was very exciting that there had been thieves in the museum and that parts of the Viking cat had been stolen. They talked a lot about the theft, and they were concerned about the thief who had been guilty of guilt and who made sure that some of the treasure came back. A kindergarten group seamed the Viking exhibition to look for the stolen objects

which was now back in the exhibition. The much talked about plastic whale and its history also made a deep impression, something one could also see in the children's drawings. Some of the children said they had a favorite room / exhibition and Egypt and the mummies were mentioned by several. A child thought the museum was scary. When asked if there were any places in the museum that were more scary, he said, "Everything is scary".

Feedback from the children gives good indications that the game has been accommodated in their everyday life in the museum. This could also be observed with their encounter with the exhibits, in the conversation between them and see when they drew. A group of children who were asked whether they had been playing in the museum all answered that they had. When the same children got the follow-up question: "When?" The cash answer came from them: "All the time".
The museum is large, like a maze with many rooms and with a lot to see. One can quickly lose focus and walk away. The sound can be a challenge with several walls of masonry and in some places it is high under the ceiling. Organizing a group of 16 curious children inside the museum were some kindergarten staff
thought a lot about. The solution came from the museum itself. In the invitation letter from the museum to the kindergarten, a mysterious figure was presented, namely Laura. Laura lay sleeping in a coffin and the children had to come to the museum and wake her up. There was a lot of excitement about who Laura was and why she was lying in a coffin. It turned out that Laura was a giant green larva that the kids could pat and snuggle with. When the children walked around the museum's many rooms, Laura was with them. The larva's bones were of hemp rope and that acted as a handle for the whole group. Each of the children could thus keep Laura and help her around the museum. At the same time, it created calm and concentration in moving as a large unit. Both children and adults loved Laura very much. Where they should go to the museum, Laura had to join.

Theft at the museum.
The story of the Viking tax theft was something that caught the children, something one could also see in their characters.

Boy drew the story of the theft in two parts
Part 2: Most of the Viking tax comes
Part 1 (above): When the thieves entered the museum.
right again.

Telling about what happened to the thieves. Here there are both fighting and good helpers. The thief as
regretted having got flowers in her hair.

The museum is at the end of a larger and resource-intensive conversion process. The project was therefore extra challenging to carry out, among other things, finding available rooms and allocating enough resources. The museum's intermediaries were responsible for several workshops / arrangements in the project. Through this work, they became a bridge-builder between the children and the museum's content and connections were made between time, space and historical events. There are many indications that the children developed a good and safe relationship with the employees at the museum. The children were on the first name with several of the mediators and some of the guides, and they often approached them with the greatest naturalness. The feedback from the kindergartens is that they were well received and in charge of the museum, and where a basic need such as having a permanent abode, dining options, opportunities for washing and access to toilets is provided.
It has been noted that several of the children have visited the museum together with their adults and shown them around after the project. A boy who brought his parents got one of the museum's hosts to unlock the Crypt.
This room had been the kindergarten's permanent base in the museum and the boy wanted to show the parents room. Feedback has also been received from the kindergarten's personnel that they have increased their interest in museums. One of them stated that she and the family had become proper museum racers and that during two weeks they had visited all five museums.
WHERE THE PROJECT IS TODAY
A lot of data must be categorized, analyzed and interpreted. It is also planned to obtain additional data via interviews and conversations with museum staff and kindergarten staff.